

and write some code. You have to take the theory that you have learned and put it into practice in your work.

We've also provided online notes for all the chapters. Each chapter has a section with discussion related to that chapter, along with links to further material. These chapter notes are meant to be expanded by the community of readers, and are available as an editable wiki at <https://github.com/fpinscala/fpinscala/wiki>.

Audience

This book is intended for readers with at least some programming experience. We had a particular kind of reader in mind while writing the book—an intermediate-level Java or C programmer who is curious about functional programming. But we believe this book is well suited for programmers coming from any language, at any level of experience.

Prior expertise is not as important as motivation and curiosity. Functional programming is a lot of fun, but it's a challenging topic. It may be especially challenging for the most experienced programmers, because it requires such a different way of thinking than they might be used to. No matter how long you have been programming, you must come prepared to be a beginner once again.

This book does not require any prior experience with Scala, but we won't spend a lot of time and space discussing Scala's syntax and language features. Instead we will introduce them as we go, with minimal ceremony, mostly as a consequence of covering other material. These introductions to Scala should be enough to get you started with the exercises. If you have further questions about the Scala language, you should supplement your reading with another book on Scala (<http://scala-lang.org/documentation/books.html>) or look up specific questions in the Scala language documentation (<http://scala-lang.org/documentation/>).

How to read this book

Although the book can be read sequentially straight through, the sequencing of the four parts is designed so that you can comfortably break between them, apply what you have learned to your own work, and then come back later for the next part. For example, the material in part 4 will make the most sense after you have a strong familiarity with the functional style of programming developed in parts 1, 2, and 3. After part 3, it may be a good idea to take a break and try getting more practice writing functional programs beyond the exercises we work on in the chapters. Of course, this is ultimately up to you.

Most chapters in this book have a similar structure. We introduce some new idea or technique, explain it with an example, and then work through a number of exercises. We *strongly* suggest that you download the exercise source code and do the exercises as you go through each chapter. Exercises, hints, and answers are all available at <https://github.com/fpinscala/fpinscla>. We also encourage you to visit the [scala-functional](http://scala-functional.org)